



1. & 3. Designer duo Shivan & Narresh's tableware line is vivid and sculptural. A set of small bowls starts from ₹5,950, while a dinnerware set costs ₹288,950

2. Abraham & Thakore's Brushstroke Collection is inspired by Japanese calligraphy. Cost of bowls starts from ₹2,500, while table runners start from ₹3,000

4. Sabyasachi's Bengale Tigris collection for Nilaya by Asian Paints has hand-painted plates



The New Aesthetic Economy

Event planners and designers are also embracing the table. Maitri Shah, founder of Mai Stories, launched her company six years ago after studying in New York. She returned to Mumbai with a vision: to make the table the storyteller.

"At that time, no one thought of the tabletop as a particularly important element of the event," says Shah. "But now it has become one of the most powerful expressions of a brand."

Her team now stages corporate and private events nationwide, doubling their annual count from 60 to 120 in just a few years. "We turn down work constantly," she admits. "The demand is overwhelming."

For India's elite, tablescaping has become a language of self-presentation—a way to display taste, affluence, and awareness. A dinner party is no longer a meal; it's a mood board. The table tells guests who you are.

What was once a quiet art of arrangement has become a booming industry—one that merges tradition with aspiration, commerce with craft. Whether it's a wedding in Udaipur or a dinner for two in Coimbatore, the Indian table has never spoken louder. **BT**

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